

Frequently Asked Questions

Client and Prospect FAQ — Cobalt Ridge Consulting Group

About CRCG

How long has CRCG been in business?

CRCG was founded in 2011 by Desmond Okafor and has operated continuously since, currently employing approximately 184 staff across five offices as of the most recent Company Profile publication.

Where is CRCG headquartered, and where else does CRCG operate?

CRCG is headquartered in Chicago, Illinois, with additional offices in Austin, Texas; Denver, Colorado; Toronto, Ontario; and a satellite office in London, United Kingdom opened in the second half of 2023.

What industries does CRCG specialize in?

CRCG has the deepest methodology assets in Manufacturing and Healthcare & Life Sciences, which together represented roughly 64% of FY2025 engagement revenue, though the firm also serves Retail & Consumer Goods, Energy & Utilities, Financial Services, and Public Sector clients.

Engagement Process

How does a typical engagement begin?

Most engagements begin with a Project Proposal outlining scope, timeline, and indicative pricing, followed by an executed Statement of Work (SOW) referencing the governing Master Services Agreement (MSA). Many clients first engage CRCG for a smaller diagnostic offering (such as OE-100 Operating Model Diagnostic) before committing to a larger transformation program.

Does CRCG offer fixed-fee or time-and-materials pricing?

Both models are used depending on engagement type. Larger transformation programs (e.g., Plant Floor Digitization, Interoperability & Integration Programs) are typically fixed-fee with milestone-based payment schedules, while diagnostic and assessment engagements are more commonly time-and-materials not-to-exceed structures.

What happens if scope changes mid-engagement?

Scope changes are documented via a formal Change Order, which is reviewed and approved by both parties before any incremental work begins or fees are adjusted. The NovaHealth and Helios Energy engagements both required Change Orders to address scope discovered after contract execution.

How is knowledge transferred to our team after CRCG's engagement ends?

Every SOW includes a defined capability hand-off plan. This typically includes documented playbooks, training sessions for client staff who will own the solution going forward, and a defined hypercare period (commonly

60–90 days) during which CRCG remains available for elevated support.

Commercial & Contractual

What is CRCG's standard payment cycle?

Most engagements bill monthly in arrears against actuals (time-and-materials) or against agreed milestones (fixed-fee), with payment due net 30 from invoice date unless otherwise specified in the SOW.

Can CRCG work with our existing technology vendors?

Yes. CRCG is vendor-agnostic and regularly integrates with clients' existing technology stack rather than mandating a specific platform, as demonstrated in the NovaHealth interoperability program, which deliberately avoided full EHR consolidation in favor of integrating existing systems.

Does CRCG require exclusivity?

No. CRCG does not require clients to exclusively engage CRCG for consulting services, though Strategic-tier accounts typically maintain a primary relationship across multiple practice areas given the efficiency of a consistent account team.

Data & Security

How does CRCG handle sensitive client data, such as PHI or financial account information?

Engagements involving regulated data categories require a Data Handling Plan reviewed by CRCG's IT Security function prior to any data access, per Section 7 of CRCG's Internal Policies & Procedures Handbook. All client data is stored within CRCG's approved cloud environment; local storage on personal devices is prohibited firm-wide.

Does CRCG use generative AI tools when working on our engagement?

CRCG staff may use approved generative AI tools to accelerate certain internal working documents, subject to strict constraints set out in Section 6 of the Internal Policies & Procedures Handbook, including a prohibition on entering client-confidential data into unapproved tools and a requirement that all AI-assisted analytical outputs be reviewed and validated by a CRCG consultant before being included in any client deliverable.